

Xiaofei Wen

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Bio

Xiaofei Wen is a CS Ph.D. student at University of California, Davis, advised by Prof. Muhao Chen.

His research focuses on improving the safety and reliability of multimodal language models and AI agents. He develops evaluation, training, and guardrail methods to help these systems make better use of input evidence and follow task and safety constraints.

Publication

[a] When Vision Speaks for Sound May 2026

Xiaofei Wen, Wenjie Jacky Mo, Xingyu Fu, Rui Cai, Tinghui Zhu, Wendi Li, Yanan Xie, Muhao Chen, Peng Qi

Preprint [paper] [webpage] [collection]

[b] Triaging Threats to Specialized Guardrails May 2026

Wenjie Jacky Mo^{*}, Xiaofei Wen^{*}, Rui Cai, Boyu Zhu, Sicong Jiang, Zihan Wang, Minglai Yang, Zhe Zhao, Muhao Chen

Preprint [paper]

[c] Video Models Can Reason with Verifiable Rewards May 2026

Tinghui Zhu, Sheng Zhang, James Y. Huang, Selena Song, Xiaofei Wen, Yuankai Li, Hoifung Poon, Muhao Chen

NeurIPS 2026 [paper] [webpage]

[d] ModelLens: Finding the Best for Your Task from Myriads of Models May 2026

Rui Cai, Wenjie Jacky Mo, Xiaofei Wen, Qiyao Ma, Wenhui Zhu, Xiwen Chen, Muhao Chen, Zhe Zhao

NeurIPS 2026 [paper] [webpage]

[e] Robust and Efficient Guardrails with Latent Reasoning May 2026

Siddharth Sai, Xiaofei Wen, Muhao Chen

EMNLP 2026 [paper]

[f] Cooking Up Risks: Benchmarking and Reducing Food Safety Risks in Large Language Models April 2026

Weidi Luo, Xiaofei Wen, Tenghao Huang, Hongyi Wang, Zhen Xiang, Chaowei Xiao, Kristina Gligorić, Muhao Chen

Preprint [paper]

[g] DebugLM: Learning Traceable Training Data Provenance for LLMs Mar 2026

Wenjie Jacky Mo, Qin Liu, Xiaofei Wen, Wenxuan Zhou, Zhe Zhao, Muhao Chen

EMNLP 2026 [paper]

[h] OmniGuard: Unified Omni-Modal Guardrails with Deliberate Reasoning Dec 2025

Boyu Zhu, Xiaofei Wen, Wenjie Jacky Mo, Tinghui Zhu, Yanan Xie, Peng Qi, Muhao Chen

Preprint [paper] [webpage]

[i] Learning Efficient Guardrails for Compliance <u>Xiaofei Wen</u> , Wenjie Jacky Mo, Yanan Xie, Peng Qi, Muhao Chen ICML 2026 [paper] [webpage]	Oct 2025
[j] REDCODER: Automated Multi-Turn Red Teaming for Code LLMs Wenjie Jacky Mo, Qin Liu, <u>Xiaofei Wen</u> , Dongwon Jung, Hadi Askari, Wenxuan Zhou, Zhe Zhao, Muhao Chen ACL 2026 [paper] [code]	July 2025
[k] Diagnosing and Mitigating Modality Interference in Multimodal Large Language Models Rui Cai, Bangzheng Li, <u>Xiaofei Wen</u> , Muhao Chen, Zhe Zhao NeurIPS 2026 [paper] [code]	May 2025
[l] ThinkGuard: Deliberative Slow Thinking Leads to Cautious Guardrails <u>Xiaofei Wen</u> , Wenxuan Zhou, Wenjie Jacky Mo, Muhao Chen ACL 2025 Findings [paper] [code]	Feb 2025
[m] Red Teaming Language Models for Processing Contradictory Dialogues <u>Xiaofei Wen</u> , Bangzheng Li, Tenghao Huang, Muhao Chen EMNLP 2024 [paper] [code]	Nov 2024
[n] Personalized Topic Selection Model for Topic-Grounded Dialogue Shixuan Fan, Wei Wei, <u>Xiaofei Wen</u> , Xianling Mao, Jixiong Chen, Danyang Chen ACL 2024 Findings [paper]	Aug 2024
[o] Sequential Topic Selection Model with Latent Variable for Topic-Grounded Dialogue <u>Xiaofei Wen</u> , Wei Wei, Xianling Mao EMNLP 2022 Findings [paper]	Dec 2022

Experience

Applied Scientist Intern , Amazon-Alexa – Bellevue, WA • Mentor: Xiang Li, Chengyuan Ma • Working on Audio-Video Model Agentic Native Detection	June 2026 – Sept 2026
Research Intern , Codedroid – Milpitas, CA • Advisor: Huan Ren • Worked on a mobile LLM-based coding assistant (Cursor-like) for on-device development workflows. • Built a pipeline to interpret user queries and localize file(s) in a code repository requiring changes.	June 2025 – Sept 2025

Education

University of California, Davis , Ph.D. in Computer Science • GPA: 3.95/4.00	Sept 2024 - Present
Huazhong University of Science and Technology , M.Eng in Computer Science • GPA: 3.90/4.00	Sept 2021 – June 2024

- **Awards:** First-Class Graduate Scholarship

Dalian University of Technology, B.Eng in Software Engineering

Sept 2017 – June 2021

- **GPA:** 3.89/4.00

- **Awards:** Mitsubishi & Outstanding Scholarship, Meritorious Winner of 2019 ICM

Service

Reviewer: NeurIPS, ICML, ICLR, ACL/EMNLP/NAACL, since 2023.

Vice President, Model United Nations of DUT, 2018-2019